

Paúl Arias Medina

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ABOUT

Researcher at the Interdisciplinary Department of Space and Population, Universidad de Cuenca (Ecuador), and lecturer at the Faculty of Psychology, where I teach statistics and quantitative research methodology. PhD candidate and fellow in the Behavioural Economics and Engineering (BEE) group at KU Leuven (Belgium). Local coordinator of CIRCLE, funded by VLIR-UOS, in collaboration with KU Leuven, UGent, ESPOL, FCD and ODJ. Primary research interest: corruption at the individual level — how citizens perceive, justify, tolerate, or reject it — combining cognitive and behavioural frameworks with experiments. Background in psychometrics and measurement validation, and in international migration and education.

EDUCATION

KU Leuven, Belgium Ph.D. Candidate · Behavioural Engineering and Economics	2022–present
Universiteit Antwerpen, Belgium MSc in Development Studies · With great distinction	2015–2016
TEC Monterrey, Mexico Specialisation in Risk Management	2014
Universidad de Cuenca, Ecuador Economist (B.Sc.)	2008–2013

ACADEMIC POSITIONS

Local Coordinator, CIRCLE Project (VLIR-UOS TEAM) Universidad de Cuenca / KU Leuven / Ghent University	2022–2027
PhD Fellow, Behavioural Engineering and Economics KU Leuven, Belgium	2022–present
Researcher and Lecturer · Faculty of Psychology Universidad de Cuenca, Ecuador	2016–present
Visiting Fellow KU Leuven, Belgium	Jan–Feb 2019
Risk Analyst Mutualista Azuay, Ecuador	2014–2015

PUBLICATIONS (CHRONOLOGICAL)

- 2026. Adaptación psicométrica del modelo de dignidad, imagen y honor en Cuenca, Ecuador**
- 2025. Psychometric properties of the Zung Self-Applied Anxiety Scale in an Ecuadorian sample**
- 2025. Are public service motivation and social value orientation related to bribery? Evidence from a developing country**
- 2024. Psychometric analysis of the Spanish version of the Identity Distress Scale in Ecuadorian emerging adults**
- 2024. Estructura factorial latente de diez modelos de la Escala Hospitalaria de Ansiedad y Depresión (HADS) en una muestra de adultos jóvenes ecuatorianos**

2024. El inventario de funcionamiento ejecutivo para niños (CHEXI): evidencia psicométrica en una muestra de escolares ecuatorianos

2023. Propiedades psicométricas de las escalas de actitudes emprendedoras para estudiantes y de inteligencia emocional de Wong y Law en universitarios ecuatorianos

2021. Factor structure, measurement invariance and psychometric properties of the WHOQOL-BREF in the Ecuadorian context

2021. Propiedades psicométricas de la versión en español del Test de Compromiso con la Vida en personas con discapacidad física

2021. Propiedades psicométricas del Cuestionario de Apoyo Social Funcional Duke-UNK-11 en adultos ecuatorianos

2021. Teletrabajo, trabajo no remunerado y violencia de género en el Ecuador durante la pandemia por COVID-19

2021. Calidad de vida y variables asociadas: Reflexiones, concepciones teóricas y los desafíos de su evaluación

2020. Estructura factorial, invarianza y propiedades psicométricas de la Escala de Autoestima de Rosenberg en el contexto ecuatoriano

2020. Propiedades psicométricas de la Escala Breve de Resiliencia (BRS) en el contexto ecuatoriano

2020. What money can't buy: Educational aspirations and international migration in Ecuador

2020. Evaluación de la calidad de los servicios públicos del Desarrollo Infantil Integral MIES

2019. Adaptation and validation of the Gratitude Questionnaire GQ-6 for the Ecuadorian context

2019. Aproximación a un modelo de bienestar en adultos ecuatorianos

2017. Fiabilidad y validez de la Escala del Continuum de Salud Mental (MHC-SF) en el contexto ecuatoriano

2017. Bienestar subjetivo y formación de cuidadores de adultos mayores

FORTHCOMING

Inside a multidisciplinary grounded-theory project on corruption in Ecuador: navigating and negotiating challenges *[forthcoming]*

Propiedades psicométricas del AUDIT en trabajadores del sistema público de salud de la provincia del Azuay, Ecuador *[forthcoming]*

UNDER REVIEW

Is, should, and culture: wording effects in cultural-norm scale measurement *[under review]*

On the comparability of regional survey data: a measurement invariance analysis of Ecuador's Violence Against Women Survey *[under review]*

Lógicas de favoritismo y confianza en redes familiares en contextos de corrupción en los Andes ecuatorianos *[under review]*

Integrating computational topic modeling with qualitative interviewing: what online and offline arenas contribute to mixed methods understanding of corruption discourse *[under review]*

A conceptual replication of a corruption coordination game in Ecuador *[under review]*

"Not corruption" makes more things corrupt: how negation widens fuzzy category boundaries *[under review]*

Percepción social de la corrupción desde la experiencia estudiantil universitaria *[under review]*

¿Modelo reflectivo o índice formativo? Evidencia psicométrica de la Escala de Riesgo Suicida de Plutchik en una muestra clínica ecuatoriana *[under review]*

Psychometric validation of scales for autonomy support and psychological control in Ecuadorian adolescents *[under review]*

Evidencia psicométrica de la Escala de Ansiedad de Hamilton en una muestra clínica institucionalizada *[under review]*

Psychometric evidence of the Beck Depression Inventory-II in a hospital-based clinical sample in Ecuador: factor analysis and item response theory *[under review]*

Neither Corrupt nor Clean: Logics of Contestation in Clientelism Exchange *[under review]*

WORK IN PROGRESS

Does ethnicity moderate corruption deals and punishments? Discrimination in cooperative and extortive corruption *[in progress]*

An experimental design on gender and norms in Ecuador *[in progress]*

Vertical and horizontal trust and its link with beliefs of institutional efficacy *[in progress]*

Measuring bribery tolerance through neutralization techniques: an experimental test using Bayesian Truth Serum *[in progress]*

SELECTED PRESENTATIONS

2026. On the understanding of corruption: online and offline data to provide a fuller picture

2026. Does ethnicity moderate corruption deals and punishments?

2024. A cognitive perspective on corruption and its boundaries

2024. A grounded theory of corruption in Ecuador: preliminary results from 3 major cities

2024. Salud mental con pandemia: un estudio de la invarianza de medición

2021. Structural validity of an instrument for the evaluation of Irlen Syndrome

2019. Examining the development agenda of three Andean countries using quantitative text analysis

2018. Las aspiraciones educativas en contextos de migración internacional: una aplicación de métodos mixtos

2018. The educational aspirations and expectations of children of transnational families

2017. La migración y el cambio cultural en el cantón Sigsig, Ecuador

TEACHING

Statistics

Undergraduate & Master's in Psychology, Universidad de Cuenca

Research Methodology

Undergraduate, Faculty of Psychology, Universidad de Cuenca

Observational and Correlational Methods

Honours Programme (in English), Universidad de Cuenca

Development Theories

Undergraduate, Faculty of Economics, Universidad de Cuenca

Macroeconomics

Undergraduate, Faculty of Economics, Universidad de Cuenca

AWARDS AND RECOGNITION

Best research poster award · VII REDU Congress · Ibarra, Ecuador

2019

Visiting Fellow · KU Leuven

Jan–Feb 2019

VLIR-UOS scholarship · MSc in Development Studies

2015–2016

SOFTWARE

R · SPSS · STATA · ATLAS.ti